WARNING SIGNS CARD

Shunt problems

Know the signs of a blocked or infected shunt

Go to the emergency department now if someone with a shunt has

- Headache with vomiting
- Drowsiness, confusion, or is hard to wake
- A fit (seizure)
- In a baby: a bulging soft spot, a fast-growing head, vomiting, unusual sleepiness, or eyes fixed downward
- Fever, or redness or swelling along the tube
- Tummy pain with fever

My shunt details

Name _____

Type of shunt and valve _____

Adjustable valve setting _____

Hospital that placed it _____

Neurosurgery team phone _____

Emergency: 112 · Ambulance: 108

Based on NHS and hydrocephalus charity guidance. General information, not personal medical advice. Checked November 2026.

Insula Neurosciences